

- 2) Discuss in brief the different steps taken in India for protection of environment.

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- 3) State in brief the principal features of national environment policy 2006.

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4.10 LET US SUM UP

We have reviewed above a brief profile of the major natural resources of India.

Undoubtedly, India is blessed with a variety of resources. But the supply of these resources is to be viewed against their requirements on the one hand and possible utilisation within the given range of technology, on the other. The potential available in a number of resources matches requirements, but the present utilisation of almost all resources falls short of the requirements. Therefore, what is immediately required is:

- 1) Intensive surveys should be undertaken within the country to explore and to identify the hitherto unknown utilisable resources. This is true in the case of both renewable and non-renewable resources. This will require chalking out an integrated multi-pronged national policy.

Equally important is the need to make an efficient use of available recorded or proven resources. This requires several interrelated steps: better technology, use of by-products, multipurpose use of resources, location of industries such that the transport cost of combining resources from different areas are minimised, etc.

- 2) There is the need to take such conservation measures that sustain the output over a longer period. Our forefathers designed institutions and practices to cope with the divergence between the individual and social rates of discount and its adverse effect on sustainable resource use. In good times and bad, by invoking the spirits or scriptures, and by creating institutions for conservation from above or below, our forebearers ensured sustainable use of natural resources. It is possible even now to revive the institutions by nurturing community consciousness.
- 3) All the above considerations will call for an effective organisational set-up. Privatisation by itself cannot be an end. In the recent past there has been

clear evidence of deals and attempts at deals for the transfer of publicly-owned resources to private hands on terms which are more than generous to the private parties and involve substantial losses in potential income as well as other costs to the public exchequer.

- 4) With rapid globalisation under way demand for scarce natural resources like land, water, mines etc. has been increasing at a fast rate. These natural resources are increasingly being grabbed by the mafia who have seen in these resources an opportunity for their sustainability. The mafia can easily hold on to this *loot* by bribing politicians, bureaucrats and other officials at different tiers of governance. Further, adverse consequences of the recent loosening up of the forest laws needs to be closely watched.

In the interest of swift economic development these considerations cannot be ignored. There is perhaps a larger role for the civil society to provide oversight and mobilise social action in this regard.

4.11 TERM-END EXERCISES

- 1) Mention in brief the different agencies engaged in task of exploring natural resources in India.
- 2) Make a brief review of the availability of soil, forest, and mineral resources in India.
- 3) Outline the need for a comprehensive natural resource use policy in India.
- 4) Outline the need for environment protection in India.

4.12 KEY WORDS

Biodiversity	: Also called <i>biological diversity</i> , it is the variety of all forms of life found on Earth.
Emerging Economies	: Economies that are transitioning from a low income, less developed, often pre-industrial economy towards a modern, industrial economy with a higher standard of living.
Governance	: Governance has been defined to refer to structures and processes that are designed to ensure accountability, transparency, responsiveness, rule of law, stability, equity and inclusiveness, empowerment, and broad-based participation.
Labour-intensive	: Labour intensive refers to a production process where the relative proportion of labour as compared to other factors of production is more.
Marginal Land	: Marginal land is land that has little or no agricultural or industrial value. Marginal land has little potential for profit and often has poor soil or other undesirable characteristics.
Unsustainable	: Something that cannot be maintained at the current rate or level.

4.13 REFERENCES

- 1) Ishwar C. Dhingra, (2020). *Resource Base of the Indian Economy*, Manakin Press, New Delhi.
- 2) Government of India: *Economic Survey*, 2018-19.

4.14 ANSWERS OR HINTS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress 1

- 1) See Section 4.2
- 2) See Sub-section 4.3.2
- 3) See Sub-section 4.4.1

Check Your Progress 2

- 1) See Sections 4.5 and 4.6
- 2) See Sub-section 4.7.3
- 3) See Section 4.8

Check Your Progress 3

- 1) See Section 4.9
- 2) See Section 4.9
- 3) See Sub-section 4.9.2

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